

JOSEPH POINTER

Chief of Staff | AI Operator and Hands-On Builder | Financial Services

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PROFILE

An operator who prototypes rather than delegates. I take loosely defined problems, form a point of view fast, and put a working version in front of real users while other people are still scoping it. I spent fifteen years inside a Fortune 100 fiduciary business at TIAA (\$1.5T AUM), most recently conceiving an AI-powered career development platform, leading the team that built it, and owning discovery, sequencing, governance with Risk, Compliance, and Legal, rollout, and measured usage. Alongside that I conceived and directed two AI products that are live in production today and designed the four-agent system inside one of them. I direct coding agents on real work daily. I am not the engineer, and the products I have shipped are the reason I do not need to be.

AI PRODUCTS I CONCEIVED AND SHIPPED

- **A multi-agent practice I operate daily, not a demo.** Each agent holds a defined role and a named gate, including an adversarial reviewer whose job is to attack the output before it ships. Before changing which model each agent runs on, I wrote down what degradation would look like for each one and set a revert-first rule, so the failure criteria existed before the change did. The gates have caught overclaims on their way into live work, including one that had already cleared several review passes. They have also missed one. I own the result either way. I published the methodology behind this practice on LinkedIn in 2026.
- **joepointer.com, including the AI assistant on it.** Entirely my own work with no one else's hands on it. Per-employer personalization, a tailored resume served per visitor, and an assistant answering questions about my background, all running in production on a Cloudflare Worker.
- **CareerPointers (careerpointers.org), co-founder.** I conceived the product and designed an 11-module career journey, a four-agent AI interview simulator, an applicant CRM, and a portfolio that adapts to each employer, then directed AI to build it on Next.js, TypeScript, and Stripe. Four months from first commit to live. I owned what AI does not decide: scope, named review gates before merge, and what we refused to ship, which included auto-apply and any fabricated match score. Mike Pointer is co-founder and engineered the production backend, the databases and security that made it real. Live, not yet opened to the public.
- **Future Me, Answered (futuremeanswered.com), live.** I conceived it, designed the 5-stage discovery framework, structured career data across 922 occupations, and developed most of the application on Next.js with multi-provider AI. Mike engineered the production backend. FERPA-aligned, serving students, counselors, and parents on scoped access.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director, Business Management

May 2011 - July 2026

TIAA, Denver, CO. Fortune 100 financial services, \$1.5T AUM, fiduciary duty under ERISA and SEC oversight.

Director, Business Management (2022-2026) | Business Manager (2016-2022) | Senior Business Management Specialist (2013-2016) | Business Consultant (2011-2013)

Owning Initiatives That Belonged to No One Function

- **Took an AI platform from idea to company-wide launch.** Opened discovery with business teams, scoped and sequenced use cases by impact, decided what shipped in each phase, and owned governance, rollout, and measurement. Released first to a transformation population, then company-wide to 16,000+ associates, of whom I reached 1,500+ directly rather than counting the ones merely given access.
- **Connected seven Client Services business areas on one operating framework.** None of the seven leaders reported to me. Named liaisons, shared strategy, and peer learning held a single approach across all of them, and I set the operating rhythm, prioritization, and resource decisions that kept it running. This is cross-functional execution without authority, which is the actual work.

- **Prototyped first, then cleared Risk, Compliance, and Legal without stalling the build.** Pressure-tested an idea before asking anyone to govern it, then brought them in to set hard limits once it was worth building. No client data or PII entered into the platform, no AI-initiated actions, and guided prompts that keep the person in control of every decision.
- **Shipped the first working version myself when speed mattered.** Produced the platform's Manager Guide on Amazon Q Developer, an enterprise-approved tool, in one week against a months-long traditional path. Separately replaced my own slide-production workflow rather than filing a request for one.

Execution Across Products, Functions, and Ambiguity

- **Delivered a cost result Finance counted.** Led 700 associates in Denver from assigned seating to a hoteling model, vacating five floors for a 44% footprint reduction. Moved 500+ Client Services associates into the new Frisco Corporate Center and shaped its design requirements with corporate real estate. Ran return-to-office across six locations for 3,000+ associates. Recognized as Change Champion.
- **Ran 30+ hands-on sessions myself.** Workshops, demonstrations, town halls, and team sessions built around work people already cared about rather than a tour of the technology. The objection was rarely the tool. It was people protecting the part of the job that made them feel valuable.
- **Designed and delivered the Skills of the Future curriculum with a team of 7.** Five tracks of 12 to 17 modules on future, digital-first, and AI skills. 890 associates engaged.
- **Earned a seat at the corporate table by building the thing first.** Ran Client Services recognition from 2014 and grew it to 34% of all company-wide recognitions in 2021, more than the next five organizations combined, on 306% year-over-year growth in associates recognized. That record put me on the corporate team selecting TIAA's next enterprise recognition platform, where I helped write the RFP, graded every vendor proposal and finalist presentation, and stayed through company-wide launch. Constructed the \$300K annual engagement budget with Finance inside roughly \$500K of program spend I administered, then reported back on what it bought.

Product Manager, Sales Engineer, Information Architect

January 2001 - March 2011

Interactive Media / FT Knowledge / Pearson Performance Solutions / Vangent, Inc., Denver, CO

A decade in enterprise software, advancing through instructional design, information architecture, project management, product management, and sales engineering.

- **Architected the Revolver LCMS content model.** Separated core content from contextual content so one authored source could publish as a full lesson, a field job aid, micro-learning, or an expert review depending on the user's context. Deployed at five Fortune 500 enterprises.
- **Carried enterprise deals as a sales engineer.** Scoped needs, facilitated working sessions, and shaped multi-year implementation plans for Unilever, Bank of America, Verizon Wireless, GE Capital, Royal Bank of Canada, and Regions Bank, and created the sales-support tools used to win and deploy them.

SKILLS

Hands-On AI: Coding agents (Claude Code, Amazon Q Developer, Kiro, GitHub Copilot) | Agentic and multi-agent orchestration | Agent delegation design | Prompt and context architecture | Output evaluation and named review gates | Model selection with revert criteria | Microsoft 365 Copilot | ChatGPT | Rapid prototyping by directing AI

Operating: Initiative ownership across functions | Discovery and use-case prioritization | Roadmap and tradeoff decisions | Workflow redesign | Operating model design | Executive read-outs and quarterly business reviews | Budget ownership and vendor selection | Change management and influence without authority

Domain: Regulated financial services, 15 years | Responsible AI governance with Risk, Compliance, and Legal | Enterprise software delivery (LCMS, ATS) | Microsoft 365 and SharePoint governance | Instructional design

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Instructional Technology | Bloomsburg University of Pennsylvania, Bloomsburg, PA | 4.0 GPA

Bachelor of Arts, Art | Millersville University of Pennsylvania, Millersville, PA

Certifications: Generative AI Leader, Google | Lean for Financial Services, TIAA, inaugural class